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THE KEY F1 DESIGN DECISIONS THAT ALLOWED RED BULL TO DOMINATE 2022

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Red Bull’s RB18 has emerged as the best of the 2022 Formula 1 cars, especially on Sundays, and could arguably be the finest the Milton Keynes-based squad has ever produced.

The year 2022 marked the long-awaited debut of the extensive changes originally planned for the previous year, which were delayed due to the COVID-19 pandemic. The changes included tighter financial regulations, which constrained spending, and revised sporting regulations that reshaped race weekends. But perhaps the most significant changes were in the technical regulations, as F1 introduced a new generation of cars designed to promote closer racing and more excitement. Despite not starting the year as the fastest car, the RB18 had to overtake Ferrari’s F1-75. The car was piloted by world champion Max Verstappen and Sergio Pérez. With Verstappen behind the wheel, the RB18 secured his second consecutive Drivers’ Championship, while Red Bull claimed their fifth Constructors’ Championship, their first since 2013. However, the RB18’s success is not just due to some magic bullet, but a combination of factors that work together to create a overall package.



Suspension

Red Bull has been a trailblazer in the world of Formula 1 suspension systems from 2009 to 2021. Their ingenious implementation of a pull-rod rear suspension and a push-rod front suspension in the RB5 car revolutionized the sport. This suspension layout was found to be the most aerodynamically superior under the then-existing regulations. Eventually, other teams followed suit and adopted Red Bull’s novel approach. However, for the 2022 season, Red Bull has made some notable changes to their suspension system for their RB18 car. While there were some exceptions, such as the testing of the pull-rod method at the front end, Red Bull’s suspension layout remained the standard for over a decade. They have opted for a push-rod layout at the rear to accommodate the larger diffuser, and a pull-rod setup at the front. The front suspension retains



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